

Javad Noorbakhsh

Bioinformatics & Machine Learning Scientist

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Education

- **Ph.D., Physics** — Boston University, Boston, MA (September 2009 - December 2014)
- **M.Sc., Physics** — Sharif University of Technology, Tehran, Iran (September 2006 - December 2008)
- **B.Sc., Electrical Engineering** — Amirkabir University of Technology, Tehran, Iran (September 2001 - December 2005)

Experience

Bioinformatics & Machine Learning Scientist, Jackson Laboratory for Genomic Medicine, Farmington, CT July 2024 - Present

- Applied pathology foundation models to accurately identify and classify blood cell types within Giemsa-stained tissue slides.
- Engineered ML algorithms to cross-evaluate and compare spatial omics profiles between human and mouse models.
- Benchmarked the impact of H&E staining variations to optimize foundation model diagnostic performance.
- Evaluated spatial transcriptomics data from cancer patient cohorts to quantify therapeutic effects on microenvironment composition.
- Formulated mathematical models of tumor evolution and subclonal dynamics, enhancing precision in treatment strategy selection.
- Co-authored peer-reviewed reviews and competitive grant proposals advancing AI applications in spatial omics.

Principal Scientist, Kojin Therapeutics, Boston, MA April 2022 - February 2024

- Spearheaded AI-driven multi-omics analysis, directly enabling fundraising and a pharmaceutical partnership.
- Established high-throughput assay screening pipelines, identifying novel small-molecule hits for drug development.
- Deployed graph neural networks (GNNs) for molecular design, accelerating target discovery and experimental drug candidate validation.
- Architected attention-based multi-instance learning pipelines on histology images, uncovering potential drug-sensitive cancer subtypes.

Lead Scientist, Broad Institute of MIT and Harvard, Cambridge, MA January 2020 - April 2022

- Orchestrated the Cancer Dependency Map omics team, managing end-to-end RNAseq, WES, and WGS pipelines to deliver quarterly releases across public, institutional, and commercial portals.
- Standardized and automated production pipelines across major projects, achieving reproducible, timely data distribution.
- Directed ML initiatives aligning patient tumor NGS data with cell lines, boosting alignment accuracy and tool reliability.

Research Scientist, Jackson Laboratory for Genomic Medicine, Farmington, CT
October 2017 - December 2019

- Pioneered a cloud-based deep learning framework for tumor state classification across histopathology images, attaining AUCs > 0.9 across 19 cancer types.
- Guided the development and deployment of an image processing framework for 3D organoid segmentation, producing an open-source software package.

Postdoctoral Fellow, Jackson Laboratory for Genomic Medicine, Farmington, CT
February 2015 - October 2017

- Investigated copy number variations and mutation calling dynamics in cancer, identifying key biomarker correlations with patient survival.
- Constructed mathematical models of clonal evolution, improving quantitative assessment of genetic heterogeneity across diverse tumor types.

Skills

Quantitative Analysis: Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Bioinformatics, Statistics, Image Processing, Mathematical Modeling, Cheminformatics

Programming: Python, TensorFlow/PyTorch, Scikit-learn, R, Bash, HPC, Cloud Computing, Containerization, Kubernetes, Version Control, C++, MATLAB

Leadership: People Management, Mentorship, Team Collaboration

Publications

- Prediction of outcome from spatial Protein profiling of triple-negative breast cancers
Ali Foroughi Pour, Te-Chia Wu, Javad Noorbakhsh, Jan Martinek, Santhosh Sivajothi, et al. — Communications Medicine, 2026
- Emerging AI approaches for cancer spatial omics
Javad Noorbakhsh and Ali Foroughi Pour and Jeffrey Chuang — None, 2025
- Germline variation contributes to false negatives in CRISPR-based experiments with varying burden across ancestries
Sean A Misk, Aaron Fultineer, Jeremie Kalfon, Javad Noorbakhsh, Isabella Boyle, et al. — Nature communications, 2024

- **The enzyme glutamate-cysteine ligase (GCL) is a target for ferroptosis induction in cancer**
John K Eaton, Priya Chatterji, Laura Furst, Sneha Basak, Javad Noorbakhsh, et al. — BioRxiv, 2024
- **High-throughput deconvolution of 3D organoid dynamics at cellular resolution for cancer pharmacology with Cellos**
Patience Mukashyaka, Pooja Kumar, David J Mellert, Shadae Nicholas, Javad Noorbakhsh, et al. — Nature Communications, 2023
- **Computational estimation of quality and clinical relevance of cancer cell lines**
Lucia Trastulla and Javad Noorbakhsh and Francisca Vazquez and James McFarland and Francesco Iorio — None, 2022
- **Associations between structural variant signatures and drug sensitivity in cell lines**
Simona Dalin, Frank Dubois, Shu Zhang, Alexander Crane, Javad Noorbakhsh, et al. — Cancer Research, 2022
- **Bridging the gap between cancer cell line models and tumours using gene expression data**
Javad Noorbakhsh and Francisca Vazquez and James M McFarland — British Journal of Cancer, 2021
- **Abstract PO-003: Deep learning identifies conserved pan-cancer tumor features**
Javad Noorbakhsh, Saman Farahmand, Ali Foroughi pour, Sandeep Namburi, Dennis Caruana, et al. — Clinical Cancer Research, 2021
- **Deep learning-based cross-classifications reveal conserved spatial behaviors within tumor histological images**
Javad Noorbakhsh, Saman Farahmand, Sandeep Namburi, Dennis Caruana, David Rimm, et al. — Nature communications, 2020
- **Repeat expansions confer WRN dependence in microsatellite-unstable cancers**
Niek van Wietmarschen, Sriram Sridharan, William J Nathan, Anthony Tubbs, Javad Noorbakhsh, et al. — Nature, 2020
- **Treating cancer as an invasive species**
Javad Noorbakhsh and Zi-Ming Zhao and James C Russell and Jeffrey H Chuang — None, 2020
- **Integrative deep learning for PanCancer molecular subtype classification using histopathological images and RNAseq data**
Fatima Zare and Javad Noorbakhsh and Tianyu Wang and Jeffrey H Chuang and Sheida Nabavi — None, 2020
- **Longitudinal molecular trajectories of diffuse glioma in adults**
Floris P Barthel, Kevin C Johnson, Frederick S Varn, Anzhela D Moskalik, Javad Noorbakhsh, et al. — Nature, 2019
- **CCNE1 amplification is associated with poor prognosis in patients with triple negative breast cancer**
Zi-Ming Zhao, Susan E Yost, Katherine E Hutchinson, Sierra Min Li, Javad Noorbakhsh, et al. — BMC cancer, 2019
- **Machine learning in biology and medicine**
PhD Javad Noorbakhsh and MS Harshpreet Chandok and PhD R Krishna Murthy Karuturi and PhD Joshy George — None, 2019
- **Distribution-based measures of tumor heterogeneity are sensitive to mutation calling and lack strong clinical predictive power**

Javad Noorbakhsh and Hyunsoo Kim and Sandeep Namburi and Jeffrey H Chuang — Scientific Reports, 2018

- **High-resolution deconstruction of evolution induced by chemotherapy treatments in breast cancer xenografts**
Hyunsoo Kim, Pooja Kumar, Francesca Menghi, Javad Noorbakhsh, Eliza Cerveira, et al. — Scientific reports, 2018
- **The PDX Data Commons and Coordinating Center (PDCCC) for PDXNet**
Anurag Sethi, Anuj Srivastava, Xingyi Woo, Vishal Sarsani, Javad Noorbakhsh, et al. — Cancer Research, 2018
- **Uncertainties in tumor allele frequencies limit power to infer evolutionary pressures**
Javad Noorbakhsh and Jeffrey H Chuang — Nature genetics, 2017
- **From intracellular signaling to population oscillations: bridging size-and time-scales in collective behavior**
Allyson E Sgro, David J Schwab, Javad Noorbakhsh, Troy Mestler, Pankaj Mehta, et al. — Molecular systems biology, 2015
- **Modeling oscillations and spiral waves in Dictyostelium populations**
Javad Noorbakhsh and David J Schwab and Allyson E Sgro and Thomas Gregor and Pankaj Mehta — Physical Review E, 2015
- **Two-dimensionality of yeast colony expansion accompanied by pattern formation**
Lin Chen, Javad Noorbakhsh, Rhys M Adams, Joseph Samaniego-Evans, Germaine Agollah, et al. — PLoS computational biology, 2014
- **Intrinsic noise of microRNA-regulated genes and the ceRNA hypothesis**
Javad Noorbakhsh and Alex H Lang and Pankaj Mehta — PLoS One, 2013